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B.D.A. AND BOYS' WELFARE

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stresses. The comfort to the body is the heat conductivity, the ease with which air can pass through the material, and the rate of moisture dissipation from the material. Test methods for determining these properties have been used by the Bureau in the selection of suitable fabrics. Also, the determination of the heat-retaining properties of blankets disclosed useful information. The heat-retaining properties of the fabric were found to be entirely a function of fibre arrangement, and not of the nature of the fibre. A cotton blanket may be designed to be equally as warm as a woollen blanket, but other conditions preclude its use for military purposes.

In July, 1917, the Ordnance Department inaugurated a system of chemical and physical tests, in all textile materials manufactured on contracts, which included inspection at the mill and the testing of selected samples at the Bureau. Inspectors at the mills provided reports of all material accepted, with an analysis of the material, including weight per linear and square yard, tensile strength, thread count, ply count, yarn number, and colour fastness tests. With these reports were submitted samples cut off from pieces adjacent to those tested at the mill. These were submitted to equivalent tests at the Bureau, and it was possible to compare and contrast the several fabrics of one type produced by different manufacturers. A marked improvement in the quality of materials below standard was in most cases effected by apprising the erring manufacturer of the results of analysis and giving suggestions for improvement. —J. B.

FOR EXPORT TRADE.

Sir Charles Mandleberg, at a meeting called to enable firms associated with the British Manufacturers' Corporation to record their opinion of the proposal to amalgamate with the Federation of British Industries for the purpose of concentrating upon the extension of overseas trade, made an interesting utterance. He said that the F.B.I., having already a large organisation, and being in touch with nearly 16,000 firms, as well as including the leading firms in the country in their list of full members, they could look forward to carrying their scheme into operation forthwith. A beginning had already been made in Spain, and further developments were in progress.

He had a vision, he said, of overseas trade commissioners—all of them men of the highest commercial qualifications, conversant with the language and customs and commercial needs of the countries to which they were appointed—established in offices suitable to their standing in the chief commercial centres of the world, with a competent staff to help them in protecting the interests of members, reporting on foreign competitors' doings, and collecting just the information needed to enable British manufacturers to get trade and keep it. He pictured the visit of a British manufacturer or his representative to a foreign country with the intention of opening up business in that market. Under present conditions such a visit provided more trials and difficulties than good results. Their scheme, on the other hand, enabled a manufacturer to be received as a welcome guest at their organisation's headquarters in a foreign country. He could send his samples beforehand; he would be advised concerning likely buyers, and he would be cautioned against doing business with this one or that. He would be given a competent interpreter to take him round if necessary. He would have been able to send particulars of the precise kind of selling agent he wanted for his line of goods, and he could be sure on arrival of being able to appoint agents of repute not employed by manufacturers in the same line of business or by foreign competitors. The commissioner and his experts would give him up-to-date information about the country's needs and possible openings. He could go on from there to another market and repeat the process. At home, if new to the export trade, he could go into one of the branch offices of the organisation and be promptly informed of all the precautions to take and the pitfalls to be avoided. These facilities, he contended, held forth abundant promise of the results desired by practical men.

The meeting unanimously agreed to join forces with the F.B.I.

B.D.A. AND BOYS' WELFARE.

The Boys' Welfare Department of the Bradford Dyers' Association have some big schemes in hand in the interests of the large number of boys in their employ, two important enterprises having recently been set on foot which will not only appeal strongly to their sporting instincts, but will be of great value as a means to health and the promotion of a sense of comradeship amongst them which cannot but be beneficial to them in their future. One of these is the "B.D.A. Football Cup Competition," whose management is vested in the Boys' Welfare Committee, acting through four local committees representing Bradford, Manchester, Leeds and Halifax. A handsome trophy, to be known as the "H. Sutcliffe Smith Cup," is to be provided, to be played for by the boys' teams from the various workshops and branches of the Association.

The other scheme is that for the establishment of swimming clubs, to be open to all *bona fide* employees of the Bradford Dyers' Association—men and boys—and to be conducted according to the rules of the Amateur Swimming Association. During the coming summer it is intended to run week-end camps, which there is every reason to believe will be very popular with the boys.

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